

Alex Bruens, Ph.D.

CONTACT INFORMATION	University of Nebraska at Omaha National Counterterrorism Innovation, Technology, and Education Center	<i>email:</i> abruens@nebraska.edu <i>web:</i> www.abruens.com
RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE	Assistant Research Professor (NTT) National Counterterrorism Innovation, Technology, and Education Center (NCITE) at the University of Nebraska at Omaha <i>As Research Fellow and Research Associate (June 2024-December 2025)</i> Research Manager Research on International Policy Implementation Lab (RIPIL) at American University Graduate Research Assistant University of Arizona	Present August 2021 - August 2024 August 2021 - May 2023
EDUCATION	Ph.D. Government and Public Policy , University of Arizona Major in International Relations, Minor in Quantitative Research Methodology <i>Dissertation:</i> "Repression in Conflict-Affected States: The Role of United Nations Peace Operations" <i>Committee:</i> Jessica Maves Braithwaite (Chair), Daniel Arnon, Susanna Campbell (<i>American University</i>), Kirssa Ryckman M.A. Government and Public Policy , University of Arizona B.A. Political Science , Arabic Minor, Florida Atlantic University <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> with Honors B.A. Sociology , Florida Atlantic University	2024 2021 2019 2019
ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS	1. "The Politics of Encampment: Pathways to Government Use of Concentration Camps," Rachel Van Nostrand, Alex Braithwaite, and Alex Bruens. (<i>Forthcoming at International Interactions</i>)	
ACADEMIC PAPERS UNDER REVIEW	2. "Deadly Persuasion: How Leaders Influence Lethality and Sustainability in Violent Extremist Organizations," Mackenzie Harms, Alex Bruens, Justin Jones, and Gina Ligon. (<i>Revise & Resubmit</i>) 1. "Resumes for Resolution: Rebel Leader Pre-War Job Experience and Civil War Negotiations," Alex Bruens, Mackenzie Harms and Gina Ligon. (<i>Revise & Resubmit</i>)	
WORKING ACADEMIC PAPERS	9. "Distinct configurations of UN missions' mandates contribute to different outcomes in conflict-affected countries," Cameron Mailhot and Alex Bruens. 8. "Understanding Transnational Criminal Organization Decision-Making Through Observable Activity: A Framework for Interpreting Organizational Behavior," Amanda Moeller, Alex Bruens, and Sam Hunter. 7. "How USAID's Withdrawal Fragmented Global Aid Networks in Conflict-Affected Countries," Jessica Maves Braithwaite, Susanna Campbell, Nuole Chen, Cecilia Cavero-Sánchez, Shahryar Minhas, Jared Edgerton, Madeline Fleishman, and Alex Bruens. 6. "Seeing the Ecosystem: Studying the Interdependence of Intervening Actors in Conflict-Affected Contexts," Susanna Campbell, Jessica Maves Braithwaite, Cecilia Cavero-Sánchez, Madeline Fleishman, Alex Bruens, and Hatem Zayed. 5. "Human Rights in the New Era of United Nations Peace Operations: Interventions and violent state repression" (dissertation chapter)	

	4. "Determinants of United Nations Peace Operations" (dissertation chapter) 3. "UN Peace Operations and Nonviolent State Repression" (dissertation chapter) 2. "Peace Accords and Post-war Civil Society" 1. "Civil Society Repression in Post-Civil War States"	
ACADEMIC WORKS IN PROGRESS	2. "Recent U.S. Terrorist Designation of Transnational Criminal Organizations and Violence," Alex Bruens, Joey Welles, Amanda Moeller, and Sam Hunter. 1. "Writing for Rights: Non-governmental organization agenda setting at the United Nations Human Rights Council," Alex Bruens, Chaelin Kwon, and Alianna Casas.	
NON-REFEREED PUBLICATIONS	2. "Book Review: Fentanyl: Fighting the Mass Poisoning of America and the Cartel Behind It by Jake Braun." Bruens, Alex. 2026. <i>Journal of Policing, Intelligence, and Counterterrorism</i>. 1. "Redefining Post-Conflict Peacekeeping Success in Regional and International Missions." Bruens, Alexander, and Mirella Miranda. 2018. <i>Florida Political Chronicle</i>, 26(1): 68—82.	
PUBLIC & POLICY ENGAGEMENT	5. "NCITE Response to Request for Information: Nebraska Unicameral Technology Committee." Elson, J. S., Bruens, A., Doctor, A., Hunter, S., Allen, M., Ligon, G. S. 2025. <i>A technical report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number, 20STTPC00001-05</i>. 4. Congressional testimony for "Match Ready: Oversight of the Federal Government's Border Management and Personal Readiness Efforts for the Decade of Sports" and responses to questions for the record delivered by Dr. Gina Ligon (<i>research support</i>). 3. "Designating Cartels and Other Organizations as Foreign Terrorist Organizations and Specially Designated Global Terrorists." Bruens, A., Harms, M. 2025. <i>A technical report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number 20STTPC00001-05</i>. 2. "Protecting American Communities from Emerging Terrorist Threats: A Guide for the Next Administration's First Year in Office." Allen, M., Bruens, A., Crenshaw, M., Doctor, A., Elson, J., Hughes, S., Hunter, S., Kearns, E., Ligon, G., Rottweiler, B., Wein, M. 2024. <i>A report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number 20STTPC00001-05</i>. 1. "NCITE Rapid-Response Report: Migration and Terrorism Nexus." Bruens, A., Ward, E., Doctor, A., Hughes, S., Ligon, G.S. 2024. <i>A technical report from NCITE based on work supported by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security under Grant Award Number 20STTPC00001-05</i>.	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Instructor of Record <i>University of Arizona</i> Spring 2026 POL 419: Terrorism and Counterterrorism Instructor of Record <i>University of Arizona</i> Spring & Summer 2024 POL 202: International Relations Instructor <i>University of Arizona</i> Fall 2023 POL 415: The Scientific Study of Civil Wars Instructor of Record <i>University of Arizona</i> Summer 2022 POL 202: International Relations Graduate Teaching Assistant <i>University of Arizona</i> 2019–2021 POL 202: International Relations	
CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION	American Political Science Association	2026

	Behavioural and Social Sciences in Security	2026
	Peace Science Society (International) Annual Conference	2022, 2023, 2025
	Political Economy of International Organization Annual Meeting	2023
	International Studies Association Annual Meeting	2023
INVITED WORKSHOPS	Bridging the Gap Project. <i>International Policy Summer Institute</i>	June 2026
	Peace Science Society. <i>New Research About Preventing Mass Atrocities</i>	November 2023
	International Studies Association. <i>Bringing Firms into Global Local Networks of Conflict Prevention and Peacebuilding</i>	March 2023
	Bridging the Gap Project. <i>New Era Workshop</i>	October 2022
GRANTS, AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS	University of Arizona Graduate and Professional Student Association Microgrant, \$250.	2024
	International Studies Scholarship Private donor, \$750.	2023
	Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR) attendance grant, School of Government & Public Policy, University of Arizona, \$3,080.	2023
	Michael P. Sullivan Graduate Research Award in International Relations, School of Government & Public Policy, University of Arizona, \$750.	2023
	Charles E., Jr. Starns Fellowship, School of Government & Public Policy University of Arizona, \$3,500.	2023
	Dissertation Fellowship, College of Social and Behavioral Sciences, University of Arizona, \$8,000.	2023
	Love of Learning Award Phi Kappa Phi, \$500.	2022
	Summer Research Grant, School of Government & Public Policy, University of Arizona, \$6,800 total.	2020, 2021
SERVICE	President Government & Public Policy Graduate Student Association Student Organizer Advocates for Youth	2021–2022 2017–2019

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